

Journey Through Hindu Wisdom

From Vedas to Bhagavad Gita to the Puranas

A Complete Beginner-to-Mastery Guide to Sanatana Dharma and Life Philosophy

Hinduism, or Sanatana Dharma – the eternal way of life – is a vast ocean of wisdom passed down through texts, dialogues, and stories. This guide provides a modern understanding of the ancient knowledge system — from the earliest hymns of the Vedas to the divine dialogues of the Bhagavad Gita and the devotional tales of the Puranas.

1. The Four Layers of Hindu Knowledge

1. **Vedas** – The foundation of knowledge, containing hymns, rituals, and cosmic laws. 2. **Upanishads** – The philosophical essence explaining the soul (Atman), universe (Brahman), and liberation (Moksha). 3. **Itihasa (Epics)** – The Ramayana and Mahabharata that apply wisdom through stories of real human challenges. 4. **Puranas** – Devotional scriptures explaining creation, destruction, dharma, and divine stories of gods and goddesses.

Bhagavad Gita (2.47): “You have the right to perform your prescribed duties, but you are not entitled to the fruits of your actions.” — *A reminder to act sincerely without attachment to results.*

2. Major Scriptures and Their Essence

Scripture	Focus / Theme	Core Learning
Vedas	Cosmic hymns, rituals	Knowledge of divine order, balance of nature
Upanishads	Philosophy, meditation	Self-realization, unity of Atman and Brahman
Ramayana	Life of Lord Rama	Ideal living, truth, loyalty, duty
Mahabharata	Dynastic war & dharma	Moral struggles, consequences, righteousness
Bhagavad Gita	Dialogue between Krishna & Arjuna	Dharma, detachment, devotion, and balance
Bhagavata Purana	Life of Krishna	Devotion (bhakti) and divine love
Vishnu & Shiva Puranas	Creation & preservation	Balance of divine energies
Garuda Purana	Afterlife, karma	Understanding death, karma, and peace

3. 12-Month Reading & Reflection Plan

Months 1–2: Read or listen to Bhagavad Gita (modern commentary). **Months 3–4:** Watch or read Mahabharata (full story overview). **Months 5–6:** Read Ramayana (Valmiki or Tulsidas). **Months 7–8:** Study Bhagavata Purana – life and teachings of Krishna. **Months 9–10:** Learn about Vishnu & Shiva Puranas. **Months 11–12:** Read Garuda Purana and explore Upanishads. Throughout: Reflect, meditate, and apply the teachings in daily choices.

Upanishads: “From ignorance, lead me to truth; from darkness, lead me to light; from death, lead me to immortality.” *May this journey bring you wisdom, peace, and understanding of your true self.*